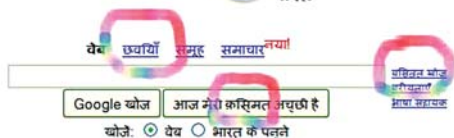


DigiPick of the month

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Last month's winner:

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Ahmedabad - 380063

Participate and
win next month:

**PC Upgrade
& Repair**

by James Pyles



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WIN!

Send in your entry and you could win an exciting gift by sharing an amusing picture with a tech angle to it. The picture should have been shot by you, and should not have been published anywhere earlier.

E-mail your picture with "**DigiPick**" in the subject line, mentioning your postal address, **on or before the 20th of this month** to digipick@thinkdigit.com. One prize-winning picture will be published each month.

upcoming hackers) did: they clicked the Edit button on the aforementioned wiki, erased all the contents, and wrote out their H4x0r (hacker-speak for "hacker") message. And that message is rather more than the icing on the cake. It tells the site administrator to "Fix your vulnerabilities in your site."

Vulnerabilities? Very apparently, the Elite Group of Hackers (or whatever they call themselves) didn't know what a wiki is. Such news elicits belly-busting guffaws from men and hankie-drenching tears of hilarity from women who do know what a wiki is.

See, we're reasonable: we'll pardon the poor grammar. Turks aren't native English speakers. We neither in India are—see?

Actually, damn the being nice. Here's the accompanying message on the main page, which slaughters the P of Poetic License: "While you were passing this roads, we were returning. While you are with girls in your dreams, we are in a war with our keyboards.... (and other such

nonsense). Defaced By KontDrakula"

The people running the Doctus Wiki (the page in question) do seem to have learnt a moral from the story: it does not now allow anonymous users to edit the wiki any more. One needs to be a registered user to do so.

There's a moral from the story for us, too: expect absolutely anything from the men of a country that names itself after a bird. Especially one that gobbles instead of chirping.

BILLS, CRAZY BILLS

The Gory Details

Justine Ezarik got her phone bill in the mail packed in a cardboard box. Shipping and handling for the cardboard box was \$7.

Now the bill was \$274.81 (Rs 11,540), the phone company was AT&T, and the now-world-famous cardboard box was large. But the two details of real interest are that the bill

was 300/- (three hundred only/-) pages long, and that Justine Ezarik uses a hallowed iPhone.

Unanswered questions abound at this point, and we'll answer them all.

Q. Why was the bill 300 pages long?

A. Because the now-famous Ezarik sent out 15,000 messages in one month from her iPhone. She didn't eat, she didn't sleep, she didn't visit the bathroom, she did nothing but type and type, and type, and type and type, and type.

Q. Are you kidding me?

A. In regards to not having visited the bathroom, we are. That's pure speculation. But how else could she have typed out 15,000 messages?

Q. So how *did* she?

A. We don't know. But then, you see, we got this bit of news off the Net like everyone else, and something could have morphed over the wires.

Q. Why did Justine Ezarik type out so many messages?

A. Because she was using her brand new iPhone! Don't you get it?

People Who Changed Computing

The Duo Behind The Dawn

Most notable amongst the firsts in computing is, of course, "the first computer." One good candidate is the ENIAC, the Electronic Numerical Integrator And Computer. The men behind the beast were J Presper Eckert and John Mauchly.



Eckert and Mauchly

We do not name the one after the other, but what we do know is it was Mauchly who'd conceived the architecture, and Eckert had the engineering smarts. The ENIAC was the first digital, commercial computer that could be programmed to solve general numerical problems—quite like what we have. It was a thousand times faster than any other calculating machine up until then (1946). And if that wasn't enough, Eckert and Mauchly led the development of the UNIVAC, which became an American household name—it had correctly predicted the outcome of a presidential election!

Mauchly, the archetypal prodigy, began experimenting with electricity very young, building a flashlight at age five. His favourite pastime (a little later, of course) was weather prediction(!). A desk calculator wasn't enough, Mauchly decided; he needed something more powerful. He was soon ordering various electronic parts, explaining, "I am intending to construct an electrical calculating machine." Famous first words.

<http://www.seas.upenn.edu/~museum/> says the ENIAC "launched the world into the computer age." Proud, perhaps true... read about it.